

Category Policy Addendum: Groceries

KARTWAY OPERATIONAL POLICY ADDENDUM: GROCERIES (DOCUMENT ID: POL-CAT-GR-04)

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Approved By: Helena Vance, VP of Customer Operations

Supersedes: POL-CAT-GR-03 (Dated January 15, 2023)

1. SCOPE AND OVERRIDE AUTHORITY * 1.1 This document establishes the mandatory customer support protocols and merchant requirements for all transactions within the "Groceries" category on the Kartway marketplace. * 1.2 This policy explicitly supersedes the Kartway Standard Return Policy (POL-GEN-01), which mandates a standard 30-day return window. Where conflict arises between POL-GEN-01 and this addendum (POL-CAT-GR-04), this addendum shall govern.

2. RETURN WINDOWS BY SUB-CATEGORY The standard 30-day return window is deactivated for all grocery items. Support agents must apply the following category-specific windows based on the delivery timestamp recorded by the carrier:

- * 2.1 Perishable Groceries (Sub-Category GR-PER):

- * 2.1.1 Includes fresh produce, meat, seafood, dairy, frozen foods, and fresh bakery items.

- * 2.1.2 The return window is exactly 48 hours from the recorded delivery timestamp. No return requests or refund claims may be initiated after 48 hours.

- * 2.2 Non-Perishable Groceries (Sub-Category GR-NPER):

- * 2.2.1 Includes canned goods, dry pasta, spices, bottled beverages, shelf-stable condiments, and boxed snacks.

- * 2.2.2 The return window is exactly 7 days from the recorded delivery timestamp.

3. CONDITION AND PACKAGING REQUIREMENTS

- * 3.1 Non-Perishable Items (GR-NPER):**
 - * 3.1.1 Original packaging is 100% mandatory.**
 - * 3.1.2 To qualify for a return or refund under "Buyer's Remorse" reasons, the outer manufacturer packaging must be completely unopened, undamaged, and with all original factory safety seals fully intact.**
 - * 3.1.3 Items returned with broken safety seals, punctured vacuum bags, or defaced nutritional labels must be rejected by the receiving warehouse, and no refund shall be issued.**
- * 3.2 Perishable Items (GR-PER):**
 - * 3.2.1 Physical returns of perishable goods are strictly prohibited due to biological safety hazards.**
 - * 3.2.2 For claims regarding spoilage, infestation, or transit damage, the customer must submit photographic evidence through the Kartway Customer Portal within 4 hours of initiating the support ticket.**
 - * 3.2.3 The photograph must clearly display:**
 - * The product expiration date or batch code.**
 - * The specific defect (e.g., mold, bruising, ruptured packaging).**
 - * The shipping label on the outer shipping carton.**

4. RESTOCKING AND PROCESSING FEES * 4.1 Buyer's Remorse Returns (GR-NPER only): * 4.1.1 All voluntary, buyer-initiated returns for non-perishable grocery items (e.g., "ordered wrong flavor," "no longer wanted") are subject to a flat restocking fee of \$6.50 per SKU. * 4.1.2 This fee is auto-deducted from the customer's refund balance during processing. * 4.2 Defective, Damaged, or Incorrect Items: * 4.2.1 No restocking fees or return shipping fees shall be assessed to the customer if the return is due to merchant error, carrier damage, or spoilage. * 4.3 Perishable Disposals: * 4.3.1 Since perishable items (GR-PER) are not physically returned, no restocking fee applies; however, a flat \$1.50 environmental disposal fee is charged to the selling merchant's ledger for any seller-fulfilled orders that result in a spoilage claim.

5. HAZARDOUS, LIQUID, AND PERISHABLE HANDLING RULES * 5.1

Return-to-Sender Restrictions: * 5.1.1 Support agents must never issue a return shipping label for perishable items (GR-PER). All approved claims for perishables must be processed as "Refund Only - No Return Required" under disposal code DISP-GROC-01. * 5.2 Pressurized and Hazardous Aerosols (e.g., whipped cream, cooking sprays): * 5.2.1 These items are categorized as HAZMAT Class 9. * 5.2.2 If a non-perishable return is authorized for a HAZMAT grocery item, the customer must ship the item via ground transport only. Shipping via air transport (Kartway Express Air) is strictly prohibited. * 5.2.3 Agents must manually assign the return label to Kartway Ground Carrier partner "Velocity Express" (Partner ID: VP-902) to ensure regulatory compliance. * 5.3 Cold-Chain Integrity: * 5.3.1 In the event that a merchant is authorized to recall a bulk shipment of temperature-sensitive items, transit must maintain a temperature threshold below 4.0 degrees Celsius (39.2 degrees Fahrenheit). * 5.3.2 The merchant must provide temperature log data (via TempTale sensors) to Kartway Operations within 24 hours of delivery to verify that the cold chain was not compromised.

6. WARRANTY AND FRESHNESS GUARANTEES * 6.1 Standard Warranty

Exclusion: * 6.1.1 The standard Kartway 1-Year Limited Warranty (POL-WRN-09) is completely inapplicable to all items in the Grocery category. The warranty

period for all grocery items is 0 days. * 6.2 The Kartway Freshness Guarantee: *

6.2.1 In lieu of a warranty, Kartway guarantees that all perishables delivered to customers must have a minimum remaining shelf life of 5 days past the delivery

date. * 6.2.2 If a customer receives a perishable product with a manufacturer expiration date printed on the packaging that is 4 days or fewer from the date of delivery, the customer is entitled to a 100% refund under Policy Code FG-RE-05.

*** 6.2.3 Claims under the Freshness Guarantee must be accompanied by a photo of the printed expiration date and must be filed within the 48-hour perishable return window.**